

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE AMENDMENT
TO
2 ENGROSSED SENATE BILL NO. 1338 By: Pugh and Hicks of the
Senate
3
4 and
5 Caldwell (Chad) and
Hasenbeck of the House
6
7

8 An Act relating to the Strong Readers Act; amending
9 Section 2, Chapter 288, O.S.L. 2023, as amended by
10 Section 9, Chapter 411, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp.
11 2025, Section 1210.508H), which relates to literacy
12 instructional team; removing language establishing
13 three-year pilot program; prohibiting certain school
14 districts that decline certain assistance from being
15 eligible for certain funds; requiring biennial
16 submission of certain report; updating contents of
17 report; updating statutory language; providing an
effective date; and declaring an emergency.

18 AMENDMENT NO. 1. Strike the title, enacting clause, and entire bill
19 and insert:
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21 "An Act relating to the education initiatives;
22 defining terms; providing the Education Impact and
23 Innovation Revolving Fund shall be used for a
24 competitive grants pool to fund education initiatives
meant to further and improve the education of
Oklahoma students; directing the State Department of
Education to administer grant program; authoring the

1 State Board of Education to award one or more
2 competitive grants to qualifying entities to fund
3 education initiatives; requiring grants be awarded
4 based on approved rubric; listing required
5 information to be submitted in grant applications;
6 requiring identifying information be removed before
7 evaluation by Board; requiring use of rubric for
8 scoring and ranking of grant applications; directing
9 grant application scores be made public before Board
10 vote; requiring Board to vote to approve grant
11 application and amount to be awarded; creating the
12 Education Impact and Innovation Revolving Fund;
13 providing for codification; and providing an
14 effective date.

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BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3-123.2 of Title 70, unless
there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. As used in this section:

1. "Board" means the Oklahoma State Board of Education;

2. "Department" means the Oklahoma State Department of
Education; and

3. "Education initiative" means a structured program aimed at
improving learning outcomes, solving specific educational
challenges, or designed to promote student achievement; and

4. "Qualifying entity" means any for-profit or nonprofit
corporation, partnership, limited liability company, association, or
any other legal or commercial entity.

1 B. The Education Impact and Innovation Revolving Fund created
2 pursuant to Section 2 of this act shall be used for a competitive
3 grants pool to fund education initiatives meant to further and
4 improve the education of Oklahoma students. The Department shall
5 administer the competitive grant program. Contingent upon the
6 availability of funds in the Education Impact and Innovation
7 Revolving Fund created pursuant to Section 2 of this act, the Board
8 shall award one or more competitive grants to qualifying entities to
9 fund education initiatives to be implemented within this state.

10 C. 1. Grants shall be awarded to qualifying entities based on
11 a rubric designed by the Department and approved by the Board.

12 2. Grant applications shall include, but are not limited to:

- 13 a. a description of the education initiative,
- 14 b. what educational need the education initiative will
15 serve,
- 16 c. the dollar amount requested,
- 17 d. the population to be served,
- 18 e. what metrics will be used to evaluate the efficacy of
19 the education initiative, and
- 20 f. if the education initiative has already been
21 implemented in any school districts within this state,
22 the data from that education initiative and the
23 efficacy of the education initiative.

1 3. Before any grant application is evaluated by the Board, all
2 identifying information shall be removed from the grant application.
3 The Board shall score grant applications using the approved rubric
4 and rank the applications according to the evaluation score. Final
5 scores of the grant application shall be made public prior to any
6 vote by the Board. The Board shall vote to approve a grant
7 application and the amount to be awarded.

8 D. The Board shall promulgate rules as necessary to administer
9 the competitive grant program created in this section.

10 SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
11 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3-123.3 of Title 70, unless
12 there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

13 There is hereby created in the State Treasury a revolving fund
14 for the State Department of Education to be designated the
15 "Education Impact and Innovation Revolving Fund". The fund shall be
16 a continuing fund, not subject to fiscal year limitations, and shall
17 consist of all monies received by the State Department of Education
18 from appropriations, gifts, grants, donations, and bequests. All
19 monies accruing to the credit of said fund are hereby appropriated
20 and may be budgeted and expended by the State Department of
21 Education for the purpose of implementing the provisions of Section
22 1 of this act. Expenditures from said fund shall be made upon
23 warrants issued by the State Treasurer against claims filed as
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prescribed by law with the Director of the Office of Management and Enterprise Services for approval and payment.

SECTION 3. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026."

Passed the House of Representatives the 6th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House of
Representatives

Passed the Senate the _____ day of _____, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

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2 BILL NO. 1338

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10 2025, Section 1210.508H), which relates to literacy
11 instructional team; removing language establishing
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eligible for certain funds; requiring biennial
submission of certain report; updating contents of
report; updating statutory language; providing an
effective date; and declaring an emergency.

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15 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

16 SECTION 4. AMENDATORY Section 2, Chapter 288, O.S.L.
17 2023, as amended by Section 9, Chapter 411, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S.
18 Supp. 2025, Section 1210.508H), is amended to read as follows:

19 Section 1210.508H. A. Beginning with the 2023-2024 school
20 year, the State Department of Education shall ~~establish a three-year~~
21 ~~pilot program to~~ employ a literacy instructional team to support
22 school districts in implementation of the requirements of Section
23 1210.508C of this title. The Department shall provide technical
24 assistance for literacy instruction, dyslexia, and related

1 disorders, and serve as a primary source of information and support
2 for schools in addressing the needs of students struggling with
3 literacy, dyslexia, and related disorders.

4 B. The Department shall employ a literacy instructional team
5 with team members who are placed regionally across the state. The
6 literacy instructional ~~teams~~ team members shall assist general
7 education and special education teachers in recognizing educational
8 needs to improve literacy outcomes for all students including those
9 with dyslexia or identified with the risk characteristics associated
10 with dyslexia. The role of the literacy instructional team shall
11 also include increasing professional awareness and instructional
12 competencies to meet the educational needs of all students including
13 those with dyslexia or identified with risk characteristics
14 associated with dyslexia. The Department shall prioritize supports
15 and interventions including enrollment in reading trainings and
16 professional development for schools which have the highest
17 percentage of students who do not demonstrate sufficient reading
18 skills as established by the State Board of Education. If a school
19 district that is prioritized for supports and interventions pursuant
20 to this subsection declines to accept assistance from a literacy
21 instructional team, the district shall not be eligible to receive
22 funds pursuant to Section 1210.508D of this title.

23 C. Literacy instructional team members employed by the
24 Department shall have training in:

1 1. The science of how students learn to read including
2 phonological awareness, phonics, fluency, vocabulary, comprehension,
3 writing, and language;

4 2. Foundation of multisensory, explicit, systematic, and
5 structured reading instruction;

6 3. Identification of and the appropriate interventions,
7 accommodations, and teaching techniques for struggling students;

8 4. The requirements of the Strong Readers Act;

9 5. Special education laws and procedures; and

10 6. Appropriate interventions, accommodations, and assistive
11 technology supports for students with dyslexia or a related
12 disorder.

13 D. The literacy instructional team members employed by the
14 Department shall report to the Program Director for Literacy at the
15 Department and have:

16 1. A minimum of five regional literacy leads, including at
17 least one who shall be designated by the Department as a dyslexia
18 specialist to provide school districts with support and resources
19 that are necessary to assist students with dyslexia. The Department
20 shall give preference to educators applying for regional literacy
21 lead who:

22 a. have an endorsement or certification as a certified
23 structured literacy dyslexia specialist or certified
24 academic language therapist,

- b. are knowledgeable of multitiered systems of support,
and
- c. have been trained in the identification of and
intervention for dyslexia and related disorders
including best practice interventions and treatment
models for dyslexia; and

2. A minimum of ten literacy specialists. The Department shall give preference to educators applying for literacy specialist who:

- a. have training in the science of reading,
- b. are knowledgeable of multitiered systems of support,
and
- c. have been trained in the identification of and
intervention for dyslexia and related disorders
including best practice interventions and treatment
models for dyslexia.

E. The State Department of Education shall electronically submit a report to the Governor, the President Pro Tempore of the Senate, and the Speaker of the House of Representatives by December 31, 2026, and by December 31 biennially thereafter, that includes an evaluation of ~~the pilot program~~ literacy instructional team members by school districts to which they were assigned, data on whether the ~~program~~ literacy instructional team members had an impact on increasing the number of students who demonstrate proficiency in reading, and recommendations for changes to the Strong Readers Act.

SECTION 5. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 6. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the Senate the 23rd day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

Passed the House of Representatives the ____ day of _____,
2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives